手会说话

One, Two, Three

Hands that can talk

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Footnotes mark names and words above HSK 1 (HSK 3.0 lists: github.com/ivankra/hsk30, MIT).

1 我今年六岁。我会说“一、二、三”，也会说“十、二十、一百”。一百是多少？一百是很多很多！一天，爷爷问我：“你会用手说吗？”我不明白。手也会说话吗？

我的手

2 我坐在爷爷旁边。爷爷说：“你看，这是一，这是二，这是三、四、五。”这个不难，我也会。“那六呢？”我问，“六要用左手和右手吗？”爷爷说：“不是。中国人用右手就能说六。你看！”

3 爷爷的右手做了一个“六”。我看了看，笑了：“爷爷，这是六吗？这不是一个电话吗？”爷爷也笑了：“是电话，也是六。”

4 “那这个呢？”“这是八。你看，是不是一个‘八’字？”

I'm six years old. I can say "one, two, three", and I can say "ten, twenty, a hundred". How much is a hundred? A hundred is lots and lots! One day Grandpa asked me, "Can you say them with your hands?" I didn't understand. Can hands talk too? 1

My Hands

I was sitting next to Grandpa. He said, "Look, this is one, this is two, and this is three, four, five." That wasn't hard. I could do it too. "What about six?" I asked. "Do you need your left hand and your right hand for six?" "No," said Grandpa. "Chinese people can say six with just their right hand. Look!" 2

Grandpa made a "six" with his right hand. I looked at it and laughed. "Grandpa, is that six? Isn't that a telephone?" Grandpa laughed too. "It's a telephone, and it's also six." 3

"And what about this one?" "This is eight. Look, isn't it the character 八?" 4

我看了半天。是，真是一个“八”字！爷爷说：“很多中国人喜欢八。”“我也喜欢八！”七、九和十，爷爷也教了我。现在，一到十，我都会了！

爷爷多大？

爷爷问：“你几岁？用手说。”我的右手做了一个电话：六！“对了！”爷爷很高兴。我问：“爷爷，那你多大？”“我六十八岁。”

六十八是多少？我用手说。一、二、三、四、五，左手没有了。六、七、八、九、十，右手也没有了。“爷爷，你的手也给我！”爷爷的手、奶奶的手、爸爸的手、妈妈的手……我们家有五口人，五个人的手都用了，还是不到六十八！

“爷爷，六十八要几个人的手？”爷爷笑了：“不用很多手。你看！”

I looked for a long time. Yes, it really was the character 八! Grandpa said, "Lots of Chinese people like the number eight." "I like eight too!" Grandpa taught me seven, nine and ten as well. Now I can do everything from one to ten! 4

How Old Is Grandpa?

Grandpa asked, "How old are you? Tell me with your hand." My right hand made a telephone: six! "That's right!" Grandpa was very pleased. I asked, "Grandpa, how old are you, then?" "I'm sixty-eight." 5

How much is sixty-eight? I counted on my hands. One, two, three, four, five, and my left hand was used up. Six, seven, eight, nine, ten, and my right hand was used up too. "Grandpa, give me your hands too!" Grandpa's hands, Grandma's hands, Dad's hands, Mum's hands... There are five of us in the family. We used all five people's hands, and we still didn't get to sixty-eight! 6

"Grandpa, how many people's hands does sixty-eight take?" Grandpa laughed. "You don't need lots of hands. Look!" 7

他的左手是一个电话，右手是一个“八”字。“这是六十八。”我明白了！我马上跑到奶奶前边，左手一个六，右手一个八：“奶奶，你看，这是爷爷！”

奶奶看了看我的手，说：“八十六？你爷爷八十六岁了？”爷爷说：“不是，不是！我是六十八！”奶奶在我前边，她看到的八在左边，六在右边。我们三个人都笑了。爷爷说：“好，好，八十六也很好。你看，八在前边！”

His left hand was a telephone, and his right hand was the character 八. "This is sixty-eight." I got it! I ran straight over to Grandma, with a six on my left hand and an eight on my right. "Grandma, look, this is Grandpa!" 7

Grandma looked at my hands and said, "Eighty-six? Your grandpa is eighty-six?" "No, no!" said Grandpa. "I'm sixty-eight!" Grandma was standing in front of me, so the eight she saw was on the left, and the six was on the right. All three of us laughed. "All right, all right," said Grandpa. "Eighty-six is fine too. Look, the eight comes first!" 8